CLEFT SENTENCES

Nivel C1

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

Partimos una frase en dos para destacar la información clave: It was Ana who… · What I need is…

1 ¿Qué es?

- Una frase partida en dos para poner el foco
- = «Fue Ana quien…» / «Lo que necesito es…»
- Énfasis, contraste y corrección

2 It is / It was … that

- It was Ana who called. (Fue Ana quien…)
- It's the noise that bothers me.
- Siempre it is / was (singular)

3 What … is / was

- What I need is a break.
- What I did was (to) call her.
- What happened was (that) I overslept.

4 All, The thing, The reason

All I want is…	= Lo único que quiero es…
The thing (that)…	= Lo que…
The reason (why)…	= La razón por la que…

5 Cuándo usarlas

- Corregir: It wasn't me, it was Tom.
- Presentar: What I'll show you is…
- Emails: The reason I'm writing is…

7 Error común

✗ What I need it's a holiday.

✓ What I need is a holiday.

lo que necesito es… → ¡sin it!

6 Consejo rápido

- «Lo que» = what, nunca ~~that~~
- «Lo único que» = all, nunca ~~all what~~
- It wasn't until X that… (no hasta)

Mini ejercicio

Completa con what, it, who, all o why.
Complete with what, it, who, all or why.

1. _____ I need is a long holiday.
2. It was Laura _____ found the error.
3. _____ was the price that shocked us.
4. _____ I want is some peace. (Lo único)
5. The reason _____ I left was the pay.

Explicación · Explanation

Lee cada recuadro despacio. Primero en español, luego en inglés. Read each box slowly: first in Spanish, then in English.

¿Qué es? · What is it?

Una **cleft sentence** (frase escindida) parte una oración en dos para poner el foco en un elemento: quién, qué, cuándo, dónde o por qué. El español hace lo mismo con «Fue Ana quien…» o «Lo que necesito es…». Como el orden de palabras del inglés es rígido y no podemos mover los elementos con tanta libertad, las cleft sentences son una herramienta clave para el **énfasis**, el **contraste** y la **corrección**, tanto en el habla como en textos formales.

A **cleft sentence** splits one clause into two to focus on one element. English word order is fixed, so clefts are a key tool for **emphasis**, **contrast** and **correction**.

Ana called the client. (neutra)

It was + Ana + who + called the client.

What + Ana did + was + call the client.

1 · It-cleft: It is / was … that / who · It-clefts

Colocamos el elemento destacado entre **It is / It was** y **that** (o **who** si es una persona). Podemos destacar el **sujeto**, el **objeto** o un **complemento** de tiempo, lugar o causa. El foco suele ser información nueva o contrastiva (fue X, y no Y). Be va siempre en **singular** aunque el foco sea plural (It was the interns who…), y su tiempo suele coincidir con el de la frase.

Put the focus between **It is / It was** and **that / who**. The focus can be the subject, the object or an adverbial. It is / was is always singular.

It is / It was + elemento destacado + that / who + resto de la frase

It was the finance director **who** approved the payment.
→ Fue el director financiero quien aprobó el pago.

It's the lack of transparency **that** worries investors.
→ Es la falta de transparencia lo que preocupa a los inversores.

It was in Geneva **that** the agreement was finally signed.
→ Fue en Ginebra donde por fin se firmó el acuerdo.

Una frase, cuatro focos · One sentence, four focuses

Foco · Focus	Neutra: Laura sent the report to the board on Monday.	Implica… · Implies
el sujeto	It was **Laura** who sent the report to the board on Monday.	Laura, no otra persona
el objeto	It was **the report** that Laura sent to the board on Monday.	el informe, no otro documento
el destinatario	It was **to the board** that Laura sent the report on Monday.	al consejo, no a los clientes
el tiempo	It was **on Monday** that Laura sent the report to the board.	el lunes, no el martes

2 · It wasn't until... / It was only when... · Not until, only when and contrast

Tres fórmulas muy rentables en el C1: **It wasn't until** + tiempo o cláusula + **that**... (= no ... hasta), **It was only when / after** ... **that**... (= solo cuando / después) y la estructura de contraste **It's not X that..., it's Y** (= no es X lo que..., sino Y). En todas ellas se usa **that**, no ~~when~~.

It wasn't until ... **that**..., **It was only when** ... **that**... and **It's not X that..., it's Y**. Use **that**, not ~~when~~.

It wasn't until + tiempo / cláusula + that + frase

It's not + X + that + ..., + it's + Y

It wasn't until the third quarter **that** sales began to recover.
→ Las ventas no empezaron a recuperarse hasta el tercer trimestre.

It was only when I read the small print **that** I understood the risks.
→ Solo cuando leí la letra pequeña entendí los riesgos.

It isn't the money **that** bothers me; **it's** the principle.
→ No es el dinero lo que me molesta; es una cuestión de principios.

3 · Wh-cleft: What ... is / was · Wh-clefts

Empieza por **What** (= lo que) + sujeto + verbo; después va **be** y, al final, la información nueva, justo donde el inglés coloca el foco natural. Es el equivalente de «Lo que... es...» y crea expectación. Muy frecuente con verbos de opinión y sentimiento: need, want, like, hate, worry, surprise, matter, concern, impress. Nunca se añade ~~it~~ antes de is.

What + clause + **be** + focus. The new information goes at the end and builds suspense. Never add ~~it~~ before is.

What + sujeto + verbo + is / was + foco

What the company needs **is** a clear long-term strategy.
→ Lo que necesita la empresa es una estrategia clara a largo plazo.

What surprised me most **was** the candidate's lack of preparation.
→ Lo que más me sorprendió fue la falta de preparación del candidato.

What really matters **is** how we respond to the crisis.
→ Lo que de verdad importa es cómo respondemos a la crisis.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

📖 Explicación · Explanation | Nivel C1

4 · What ... did was + infinitivo · Focusing on actions and events

Para destacar una **acción** usamos **do** en la primera parte: What I did **was**... Detrás de be va el **infinitivo** con o sin to (sin to es más frecuente): What she did was (to) resign. El tiempo lo marca do: What we're going to do is... Si la primera parte va en continuo, el foco va en **-ing**: What I'm doing is **trying** to help. Para destacar **todo un suceso**: **What happened was (that)** + frase completa.

To focus on an action, use **do**: What I did was (to) + infinitive. For a whole event: **What happened was (that)**...

What + sujeto + do / did / will do + be + (to) infinitivo

What happened + was + (that) + frase completa

What the CEO **did was** (to) cut her own salary by 30%.
→ Lo que hizo la consejera delegada fue recortarse el sueldo un 30 %.

What we're going to **do is** review every single contract.
→ Lo que vamos a hacer es revisar todos y cada uno de los contratos.

What happened was that the server crashed during the presentation.
→ Lo que pasó fue que el servidor se cayó durante la presentación.

5 · All, The thing, The reason... · Other cleft patterns

Variantes muy naturales: **All** (that) = lo único que (All I want is...; nunca ~~all what~~); **The (only / main) thing (that)**; **The reason (why) ... is that / is to** + infinitivo (nunca ~~the reason because~~); **The person who, The place where, The day when**. También con **where** y **why** en wh-cleft: Where we went wrong was...

All (that), the thing (that), the reason (why), the person who, the place where... + **be** + focus. Never ~~all what~~ or ~~the reason because~~.

All / The thing / The reason (why) + cláusula + is / was + foco

All we're asking for **is** a fair hearing.
→ Lo único que pedimos es que se nos escuche con imparcialidad.

The reason why the project failed **was that** nobody took responsibility.
→ La razón por la que fracasó el proyecto fue que nadie asumió la responsabilidad.

The thing that impressed me most **was** her attention to detail.
→ Lo que más me impresionó fue su atención al detalle.

The place where we first met **was** a small café in Lisbon.
→ El sitio donde nos conocimos fue un pequeño café de Lisboa.

Truco del «lo que» · The «lo que» trick

Si en español empiezas con **«Lo que...»**, en inglés empieza con **What...** (nunca ~~That~~). Si dices **«Es / Fue X quien / lo que / donde...»**, piensa en **It is / was X that / who...**. Para **«lo único que»**, **All**. En una presentación, abrir con What I'd like to do today is... suena seguro y profesional.

«Lo que...» → **What...** · «Es / Fue X quien...» → **It is / was X that / who...** · «Lo único que...» → **All...**

6 · Al revés: That's what... / This is where... · Reversed wh-clefts

Podemos dar la vuelta al wh-cleft y poner el foco **al principio**: A good rest **is what** you need. Con **this / that** es una fórmula muy natural en conversaciones y presentaciones: **That's what** I mean · **This is where** things get complicated · **That's why** we're here · **That's how** it works.

Reversed wh-clefts put the focus first: A good rest is what you need. With **this / that** they are very common in speech.

Foco / This / That + **is** + what / where / why / how + cláusula

Transparency **is what** our clients expect.
→ La transparencia es lo que esperan nuestros clientes.

This is where the plan starts to fall apart.
→ Aquí es donde el plan empieza a venirse abajo.

That's why we decided to postpone the launch.
→ Por eso decidimos aplazar el lanzamiento.

Tabla resumen · Summary table

Tipo · Type	Estructura	Para qué	Ejemplo · Example
It-cleft	It is / was + foco + that / who...	destacar un elemento	It was Ana who signed it.
It + until / only when	It wasn't until / It was only when ... that...	no ... hasta / solo cuando	It wasn't until 2020 that we expanded.
Contraste	It's not X that..., it's Y	corregir o contrastar	It's not the price that matters, it's the quality.
Wh-cleft	What + cláusula + be + foco	lo que ... es ...	What we need is time.
Acción / suceso	What ... did was (to) + inf. · What happened was...	destacar una acción	What I did was call him.
All / The thing / The reason	All / The thing / The reason (why) ... + be...	lo único que / la razón...	All I need is a coffee.

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📖 **Explicación** · Explanation | **Nivel C1**

It-cleft frente a wh-cleft · It-cleft vs wh-cleft

Con **It** el foco va **delante** y suele marcar contraste (¡fue X, no Y!). Con **What** el foco va **al final** y crea expectación. Las dos traducen el «es … lo que / fue … quien» del español.

It-clefts put the focus first (often contrastive); **wh**-clefts put it last, building suspense.

🎯 It-cleft · foco delante

- It was **Tom** who broke it (not me).
- It's **the noise** that I can't stand.
- It was **in 2015** that we met.
- It's **you** I want to talk to.

Wh-cleft · foco al final

- What broke it was **the dog**.
- What I can't stand is **the noise**.
- What I want is **to talk to you**.
- What we did was **move to London**.

Más ejemplos en contexto · More examples in context

It was the junior analyst **who** spotted the error in the accounts.
→ Fue la analista júnior quien detectó el error en las cuentas.

What I'd like to focus on today **is** customer retention.
→ En lo que me gustaría centrarme hoy es en la fidelización de clientes.

It's precisely this kind of short-term thinking **that** has damaged the industry.
→ Es precisamente este tipo de mentalidad cortoplacista lo que ha dañado al sector.

What the report fails to mention **is** the environmental cost.
→ Lo que el informe no menciona es el coste medioambiental.

All the committee has done so far **is** postpone the decision.
→ Lo único que ha hecho el comité hasta ahora es aplazar la decisión.

It was not until the 1990s **that** the theory gained acceptance.
→ La teoría no fue aceptada hasta los años noventa.

Más ejemplos en contexto · More examples in context (continúa · cont.)

The main reason why sales fell **was** the rise in interest rates.
→ La razón principal por la que cayeron las ventas fue la subida de los tipos de interés.

What concerns me **is** not the cost but the timing.
→ Lo que me preocupa no es el coste, sino el momento.

It is the government, not local councils, **that** must take responsibility.
→ Es el Gobierno, y no los ayuntamientos, quien debe asumir la responsabilidad.

Where we went wrong **was** in underestimating the competition.
→ Donde nos equivocamos fue al subestimar a la competencia.

The person you should speak to **is** the head of HR.
→ La persona con la que deberías hablar es la directora de Recursos Humanos.

That's exactly what we're trying to avoid.
→ Eso es justo lo que intentamos evitar.

¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~What I need it's a holiday.~~
✓ **What** I need **is** a holiday.
Calco de «lo que necesito es»: sobra it. / No extra it before is.

✗ ~~That I like most is his honesty.~~
✓ **What** I like most is his honesty.
«Lo que» al inicio = what, nunca that. / «Lo que» = what.

✗ ~~All what we want is a fair deal.~~
✓ **All (that)** we want is a fair deal.
«Todo lo que / lo único que» = all (that). / All (that), never all what.

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¡Caza al monstruo! · Hunt the monster (cont.)

Monstruo del error

✗ ~~What I did was I called the police.~~

✓ What I did was (to) call the police.

Tras what … do + be → infinitivo. / Use the infinitive after be.

✗ ~~Is the noise what bothers me.~~

✓ It's the noise that bothers me.

Calco de «Es el ruido lo que…»: hace falta it… that. / It + be + focus + that.

✗ ~~It were the interns who noticed it.~~

✓ It was the interns who noticed it.

It is / was siempre en singular. / It is / was is always singular.

✗ ~~The reason because I resigned was the pay.~~

✓ The reason (why) I resigned was the pay.

«La razón por la que» = the reason why / that. / The reason why, not because.

✗ ~~It is for this reason why we oppose the plan.~~

✓ It is for this reason that we oppose the plan.

En el it-cleft, el nexo es that. / It-clefts take that.

¿Cómo construyo una cleft sentence? · How do I build it?

1. Escribe la frase neutra y decide **qué quieres destacar**: The delay annoyed the clients.
   🇬🇧 Write the neutral sentence and choose the focus.
2. ¿Foco **delante**, con contraste (fue X, no Y)? → **It was** the delay **that** annoyed the clients.
   🇬🇧 Focus first, contrastive → It was … that.
3. ¿Foco **al final**, creando expectación? → **What** annoyed the clients **was** the delay.
   🇬🇧 Focus last, suspense → What … was.

¿Cómo construyo una cleft sentence? · How do I build it?

(continúa · cont.)

4. ¿Destacas una **acción**? Usa **do**: What we did was (to) apologise.
   🇬🇧 Action → What … did was (to) + infinitive.
5. Revisa: **what** (no ~~that~~) para «lo que», **that / who** tras el foco, un solo **be** y sin ~~it~~ extra.
   🇬🇧 Check: what, that / who, one be, no extra it.

Reunión de equipo · Team meeting

Director — So, what went wrong with the launch?
Bueno, ¿qué falló en el lanzamiento?

Marta — Well, it wasn't the product that failed. It was the timing.
Bueno, no fue el producto lo que falló. Fue el momento.

Director — What do you mean exactly?
¿Qué quieres decir exactamente?

Marta — What happened was that our main competitor launched a similar app a week earlier.
Lo que pasó fue que nuestro principal competidor lanzó una app parecida una semana antes.

Director — And why didn't we react?
¿Y por qué no reaccionamos?

Marta — The reason why we didn't react was that nobody had analysed the market.
La razón por la que no reaccionamos fue que nadie había analizado el mercado.

Reunión de equipo · Team meeting (continúa · cont.)

Director So what do you suggest?
Entonces, ¿qué propones?

Marta What we need is a proper research team. All I'm asking for is two analysts.
Lo que necesitamos es un equipo de investigación de verdad. Lo único que pido son dos analistas.

Ejercicios · Practice

Escribe con lápiz y letra clara. Antes de escribir, piensa qué regla toca. Write in pencil. Think about the rule first.

Name · Nombre _____ Date · Fecha _____ Score _____

Ejercicio 1 ¿Qué estructura necesito? · Which structure?

¿Cómo empezarías cada frase en inglés? Escribe cada expresión española en su caja.
How would you start each sentence in English? Sort the Spanish phrases.

Word bank

- Lo único que pido es…
- Lo único que hizo fue…
- Fue en 2010 cuando…
- Fue el ruido lo que…
- Lo que quiero es…
- Lo único que falta es…
- No fue hasta mayo que…
- Fue Ana quien…
- Lo que me preocupa es…
- Lo único que necesito es…
- Lo que hice fue…
- Lo que pasó fue que…

It is / was … that / who	What … is / was	All … is / was

Ejercicio 2 Rodea la correcta · Circle the correct option

Rodea la opción correcta.
Circle the correct option.

1. (What) / (That) I need is a good night's sleep.
2. It was the manager (who) / (which) made the final decision.
3. (It) / (What) was the price that put me off.

Ejercicio 2 Rodea la correcta · Circle the correct option

(continúa · cont.)

4. What I need (is) / (it's) more time.
5. All (what) / (that) I want is a quiet weekend.
6. What she did was (resign) / (resigned) on the spot.
7. It wasn't until midnight (that) / (when) the results came in.
8. The reason (because) / (why) I left was the commute.
9. It (was) / (were) the students who organised the protest.
10. (This) / (It) is where the story gets interesting.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

✏️ Ejercicios · Practice | Nivel C1

Ejercicio 3 Une las dos mitades · Match the halves

✍️ Une el principio de cada frase con su final.
🇬🇧 Match the beginnings with the endings.

1 It was my sister	a who taught me to drive.
2 What I find most irritating	b is the client's signature.
3 All we need now	c is the constant noise.
4 It wasn't until I moved to London	d that I realised how expensive life could be.
5 The reason why I'm calling	e the train broke down outside Oxford.
6 What happened was that	f is to confirm tomorrow's meeting.
7 It's not the salary that matters,	g it's the working atmosphere.
8 What she did was	h hand in her notice the next morning.

Ejercicio 4 ¿Correcta o incorrecta? · Correct or incorrect?

✍️ Marca T si la frase es correcta y F si es incorrecta. Si es incorrecta, corrígela en tu cuaderno.
🇬🇧 Tick T if the sentence is correct and F if it is wrong.

1 What I need is a holiday. T F
2 What I need it's a holiday. T F
3 It was my parents who paid for the wedding. T F

Ejercicio 4 ¿Correcta o incorrecta? · Correct or incorrect? (continúa · cont.)

4 It were the managers who decided. T F
5 All what I want is some peace. T F
6 What we did was to cancel the trip. T F
7 It wasn't until Friday that we heard the news. T F
8 That I like most is the food. T F
9 The reason why I left was the long hours. T F
10 Is the price what worries me. T F

Ejercicio 5 La palabra que falta · The missing word

✍️ Completa con una palabra del recuadro. Algunas palabras se repiten o no se usan.
🇬🇧 Complete with one word from the box.

Word bank it · what · that · all · why · did · where · was · is

1 _____ was my grandfather who taught me to play chess.
2 _____ I admire most about her is her honesty.
3 It was the IT department _____ discovered the breach.
4 _____ we need now is a bit of luck.
5 The reason _____ I'm writing is to complain about the service.
6 What the team _____ was work through the night.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

Ejercicio 5 La palabra que falta · The missing word (continúa · cont.)

7 The place _____ I feel most relaxed is my grandmother's village.

8 It wasn't until she spoke _____ I recognised her voice.

9 What surprised everyone _____ the speed of the recovery.

10 It _____ the details that make the difference.

Ejercicio 6 El verbo correcto · The correct verb form

Escribe la forma correcta del verbo entre paréntesis.
Write the correct form of the verb in brackets.

1 What she did was _____ for a transfer. (apply)

2 What I'm doing is _____ to help you. (try)

3 What we've done is _____ our prices. (reduce)

4 What happened _____ that nobody turned up. (be)

5 It _____ my colleagues who suggested the idea. (be)

6 What I need _____ a few days off. (be)

7 All I did _____ ask a simple question. (be)

8 What they're going to do is _____ a new branch. (open)

9 It _____ until last week that I found out. (not / be)

10 The reason why prices rose _____ that demand increased. (be)

Ejercicio 7 Una frase, dos clefts · One sentence, two clefts

Transforma cada frase neutra en una it-cleft y en una wh-cleft. Destaca la parte **en negrita**.
Turn each sentence into an it-cleft and a wh-cleft. Focus on the part in bold.

Frase neutra · Neutral	It-cleft	Wh-cleft
The rain ruined the match.	_____	_____
I need **a holiday**.	_____	_____
Her attitude annoys me.	_____	_____

Ejercicio 7 — Una frase, dos clefts · One sentence, two clefts (continúa · cont.)

Frase neutra · Neutral	It-cleft	Wh-cleft
We lack **experience**.	_____	_____
The noise kept me awake.	_____	_____
They want **a pay rise**.	_____	_____

Ejercicio 8 — Ordena la frase · Put the words in order

✍️ Ordena las palabras para formar una cleft sentence. Añade mayúscula y punto.
🇬🇧 Put the words in order to make a cleft sentence.

1. was · who · it · Laura · the mistake · noticed

2. need · is · what · we · more time

3. all · want · I · is · a quiet life

4. until · it · wasn't · that · I · arrived · I · noticed · the damage

5. happened · what · was · that · the system · crashed

Ejercicio 8 — Ordena la frase · Put the words in order (continúa · cont.)

6. the reason · I · why · am · calling · is · to complain

7. did · what · was · she · resign · immediately

8. it's · not · the price · that · worries · me

Ejercicio 9 Reescribe con énfasis · Rewrite with emphasis

✍️ Reescribe cada frase como cleft sentence empezando por las palabras entre paréntesis.
🇬🇧 Rewrite each sentence as a cleft sentence. Start with the words in brackets.

1. The manager approved the budget. (It was…)
2. I lost my keys at the airport. (It was at…)
3. We only understood the problem when the client complained. (It was only when…)
4. The company didn't make a profit until 2021. (It wasn't until…)
5. His arrogance irritates me. (What…)
6. We need a more flexible approach. (What…)
7. She sold her shares. (What she did…)
8. I only want a straight answer. (All…)

Ejercicio 9 Reescribe con énfasis · Rewrite with emphasis (continúa · cont.)

9. I'm calling to cancel my order. (The reason…)
10. The server crashed during the demo. (What happened…)

Ejercicio 10 Corrige con contraste · Correct with contrast

✍️ Alguien se equivoca. Corrígele con una cleft de contraste: No, it wasn't / isn't X who / that…; it was / is Y.
🇬🇧 Correct the information with a contrastive cleft.

1. Sara sent the email. (Marta)
2. The price worries the clients. (the quality)
3. We're meeting the client on Thursday. (Friday)
4. You need more money. (more time)
5. The Spanish team won the final. (the Italian team)

Ejercicio 10 — Corrige con contraste · Correct with contrast (continúa · cont.)

6 They built the bridge in 1990. (1985)

7 Your brother called. (my cousin)

8 The noise annoys you. (the smell)

Ejercicio 11 — Caza el error · Find the mistake

✍️ Cada frase tiene UN error. Escríbela bien.
🇬🇧 Each sentence has ONE mistake. Correct it.

1 ✗ What I need it's a long rest.
✓

2 ✗ It were the neighbours who called the police.
✓

3 ✗ All what she said was "no comment".
✓

4 ✗ What he did was he resigned.
✓

Ejercicio 11 — Caza el error · Find the mistake (continúa · cont.)

5 ✗ The reason because I'm late is the traffic.
✓

6 ✗ That surprised me was her reaction.
✓

7 ✗ It wasn't until 2015 when I started my own business.
✓

8 ✗ It's for this reason why we cannot accept your offer.
✓

9 ✗ Is the attitude what matters.
✓

10 ✗ The thing what worries me is the deadline.
✓

Ejercicio 12 — Transformaciones C1 Advanced · Key word transformations

✍️ Completa la segunda frase para que signifique lo mismo que la primera. Usa la palabra clave sin cambiarla y entre 3 y 6 palabras en total. (En el solucionario aparecen las palabras que faltan.)

🇬🇧 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the key word and 3–6 words.

1 I only realised how late it was when I looked at the clock. 🔑 UNTIL
It _____ at the clock that I realised how late it was.

2 Her lack of experience worries me. 🔑 WHAT
_____ her lack of experience.

3 The only thing she did was complain. 🔑 ALL
_____ complain.

4 Sam broke the printer, not Jo. 🔑 WHO
It _____ the printer, not Jo.

5 I'm writing to apply for the post of marketing manager. 🔑 REASON
The _____ is to apply for the post of marketing manager.

Ejercicio 12 — Transformaciones C1 Advanced · Key word transformations (continúa · cont.)

6 The match was cancelled because of the storm. 🔑 IT
_____ caused the match to be cancelled.

7 The company decided to relocate to Dublin. 🔑 DID
What _____ to Dublin.

8 We need to focus on customer service. 🔑 NEED
What _____ on is customer service.

9 I didn't understand the plot until the very last scene. 🔑 WAS
It _____ the very last scene that I understood the plot.

10 I can't forgive his dishonesty. 🔑 THING
The _____ forgive is his dishonesty.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English

✍️ Traduce usando una cleft sentence. ¿«Fue X quien…» o «Lo que… es…»?
Translate into English using a cleft sentence.

1. Fue mi madre quien me enseñó a cocinar.
2. Lo que necesitamos es un plan B.
3. Lo único que quiero es dormir.
4. No fue hasta el viernes cuando nos dieron los resultados.
5. Lo que hizo fue colgar el teléfono. (él)
6. La razón por la que te llamo es para invitarte a la boda.
7. Lo que me molesta es su falta de puntualidad. (de ella)
8. Fue en Roma donde se conocieron.
9. Lo que pasó fue que perdimos el último tren. (¡ojo con «perder»!)

Ejercicio 13 Traduce al inglés · Translate into English (continúa · cont.)

10. No es el dinero lo que importa, sino la experiencia.

Ejercicio 14 Lee y contesta · Read and answer

✍️ Lee el texto (parte de una charla de una emprendedora). Marca T o F y contesta las preguntas.
Read the talk. Tick T or F and answer the questions.

Why our start-up nearly failed

When people ask me what nearly destroyed our start-up, they expect me to say money. But it wasn't money that almost finished us. It was silence. What I mean is that, for almost a year, nobody in the team dared to tell me the truth.

It was only when our biggest client left that I started asking questions. What I discovered was shocking: our developers had been warning about serious bugs for months, but their emails never reached me. The reason why they never reached me was simple: my managers were afraid of my reaction.

What we did next changed everything. We introduced a weekly meeting where anyone can say anything. All I ask is that people are honest and respectful. It's this culture of openness, not our product, that our clients value most today.

1. Money was the main problem for the start-up. T F
2. The author started asking questions after losing a major client. T F
3. The developers had never reported any problems. T F

Ejercicio 14 Lee y contesta · Read and answer (continúa · cont.)

4 Why did the developers' emails never reach the author?

5 What did the company introduce?

6 Copy the sentence that begins with All.

7 Rewrite without a cleft: "It's this culture of openness that our clients value most today."

8 Rewrite as a wh-cleft: "Silence almost finished us."

Ejercicio 15 Ahora escribe tú · Your turn

✍️ Escribe frases propias con cleft sentences, pensando en situaciones reales de trabajo o estudio.
🇬🇧 Write your own cleft sentences for real work or study situations.

1 Empieza una presentación con **What I'd like to talk about today is…**

2 Corrige un malentendido con **It wasn't … who / that …; it was …**

3 Explica el motivo de un email formal con **The reason why I am writing is…**

4 Cuenta un problema con **What happened was that…**

5 Expresa un deseo con **All I…** y una opinión con **What really matters is…**

¿Lo he aprendido? · Can I do it?

Marca cada frase cuando la sepas hacer y colorea las estrellas. Tick each line when you can do it and colour the stars.

Lo sé hacer · I can...

- [ ] Construyo **It is / was … that / who** para destacar quién, qué, cuándo o dónde. ☆☆☆
  I can build it-clefts.
- [ ] Uso **What … is / was** para «lo que … es». ☆☆☆
  I can build wh-clefts.
- [ ] Destaco acciones con **What I did was (to) + infinitivo** y sucesos con **What happened was…** ☆☆☆
  I can focus on actions and events.
- [ ] Uso **All, The thing, The reason why** y **The place where.** ☆☆☆
  I can use all, the thing, the reason why…
- [ ] Uso **It wasn't until … that** y **It's not X that…, it's Y.** ☆☆☆
  I can use not until and contrastive clefts.
- [ ] Evito ~~What I need it's~~, ~~all what~~ y ~~the reason because~~. ☆☆☆
  I avoid typical Spanish-speaker mistakes.

Mi progreso · My progress

Colorea 1, 2 o 3 estrellas en cada ejercicio. Colour 1, 2 or 3 stars for each exercise.

Ej. 1 ☆☆☆	Ej. 2 ☆☆☆	Ej. 3 ☆☆☆	Ej. 4 ☆☆☆
Ej. 5 ☆☆☆	Ej. 6 ☆☆☆	Ej. 7 ☆☆☆	Ej. 8 ☆☆☆
Ej. 9 ☆☆☆	Ej. 10 ☆☆☆	Ej. 11 ☆☆☆	Ej. 12 ☆☆☆
Ej. 13 ☆☆☆	Ej. 14 ☆☆☆	Ej. 15 ☆☆☆	

Solucionario · Answer key

Para el adulto que corrige (¡o para comprobar después de hacerlo!). For the grown-up who checks, or to check after you finish.

Mapa · Mini ejercicio

1. What · 2. who / that · 3. It · 4. All · 5. why / that

Ejercicio 1 · ¿Qué estructura necesito?

It is / was … that / who: Fue Ana quien…, Fue en 2010 cuando…, No fue hasta mayo que…, Fue el ruido lo que…
What … is / was: Lo que quiero es…, Lo que hice fue…, Lo que pasó fue que…, Lo que me preocupa es…
All … is / was: Lo único que pido es…, Lo único que falta es…, Lo único que hizo fue…, Lo único que necesito es…

Ejercicio 2 · Rodea la correcta

1. What · 2. who · 3. It · 4. is · 5. that · 6. resign · 7. that · 8. why · 9. was · 10. This

Ejercicio 3 · Une las dos mitades

1-a · 2-c · 3-b · 4-d · 5-f · 6-e · 7-g · 8-h

Ejercicio 4 · ¿Correcta o incorrecta?

1. True ✓
2. False ✗ — What I need is a holiday.
3. True ✓ — it was (singular) aunque el foco sea plural.
4. False ✗ — It was the managers who decided.
5. False ✗ — All (that) I want is some peace.
6. True ✓ — to es opcional.
7. True ✓

Ejercicio 4 · ¿Correcta o incorrecta? (continúa · cont.)

8. False ✗ — What I like most is the food.
9. True ✓
10. False ✗ — It's the price that worries me.

Ejercicio 5 · La palabra que falta

1. It · 2. What · 3. that / who · 4. All / What · 5. why / that · 6. did · 7. where · 8. that · 9. was · 10. is

Ejercicio 6 · El verbo correcto

1. apply / to apply · 2. trying · 3. reduce / to reduce · 4. was · 5. was · 6. is · 7. was · 8. open / to open · 9. wasn't / was not · 10. was

Ejercicio 7 · Una frase, dos clefts

Frase neutra · Neutral	It-cleft	Wh-cleft
The rain ruined the match.	It was the rain that ruined the match.	What ruined the match was the rain.
I need a holiday.	It's a holiday (that) I need.	What I need is a holiday.
Her attitude annoys me.	It's her attitude that annoys me.	What annoys me is her attitude.
We lack experience.	It's experience (that) we lack.	What we lack is experience.
The noise kept me awake.	It was the noise that kept me awake.	What kept me awake was the noise.
They want a pay rise.	It's a pay rise (that) they want.	What they want is a pay rise.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

Solucionario · Answer key | **Nivel C1**

Ejercicio 8 · Ordena la frase

1. It was Laura who noticed the mistake.
2. What we need is more time.
3. All I want is a quiet life.
4. It wasn't until I arrived that I noticed the damage.
5. What happened was that the system crashed.
6. The reason why I am calling is to complain.
7. What she did was resign immediately.
8. It's not the price that worries me.

Ejercicio 9 · Reescribe con énfasis

1. It was the manager who (that) approved the budget.
2. It was at the airport that I lost my keys.
3. It was only when the client complained that we understood the problem.
4. It wasn't until 2021 that the company made a profit.
5. What irritates me is his arrogance.
6. What we need is a more flexible approach.
7. What she did was (to) sell her shares.
8. All I want is a straight answer.
9. The reason (why) I'm calling is to cancel my order.
10. What happened was (that) the server crashed during the demo.

Ejercicio 10 · Corrige con contraste

1. No, it wasn't Sara who sent the email; it was Marta.
2. No, it isn't the price that worries the clients; it's the quality.
3. No, it isn't on Thursday that we're meeting the client; it's on Friday.
4. No, it isn't more money (that) I need; it's more time.
5. No, it wasn't the Spanish team that won the final; it was the Italian team.
6. No, it wasn't in 1990 that they built the bridge; it was in 1985.
7. No, it wasn't my brother who called; it was my cousin.
8. No, it isn't the noise that annoys me; it's the smell.

Ejercicio 11 · Caza el error

1. What I need is a long rest.
2. It was the neighbours who called the police.
3. All (that) she said was "no comment".
4. What he did was (to) resign.
5. The reason (why) I'm late is the traffic.
6. What surprised me was her reaction.
7. It wasn't until 2015 that I started my own business.
8. It's for this reason that we cannot accept your offer.
9. It's the attitude that matters.
10. The thing that worries me is the deadline.

Ejercicio 12 · Transformaciones C1 Advanced

1. wasn't until I looked · 2. What worries me is · 3. All she did was · 4. was Sam who broke · 5. reason (why) I am writing · 6. It was the storm that · 7. the company did was (to) relocate · 8. we need to focus · 9. was not until · 10. thing (that) I can't

Ejercicio 13 · Traduce al inglés

1. It was my mother who taught me to cook.
2. What we need is a plan B.
3. All I want is to sleep. / All I want to do is sleep.
4. It wasn't until Friday that they gave us the results.
5. What he did was (to) hang up (the phone).
6. The reason (why) I'm calling is to invite you to the wedding.
7. What annoys (bothers) me is her lack of punctuality.
8. It was in Rome that they met.
9. What happened was (that) we missed the last train.
10. It isn't the money that matters; it's the experience.

CLEFT SENTENCES

Cleft sentences · frases escindidas para dar énfasis

Solucionario · Answer key

Nivel C1

Ejercicio 14 · Lee y contesta

1. False ✗ — It wasn't money that almost finished us. It was silence.
2. True ✓ — It was only when our biggest client left that…
3. False ✗ — They had been warning about serious bugs for months.
4. Because the managers were afraid of her reaction.
5. A weekly meeting where anyone can say anything.
6. All I ask is that people are honest and respectful.
7. Our clients value this culture of openness most today.
8. What almost finished us was silence.

Ejercicio 15 · Ahora escribe tú

1. Ej.: What I'd like to talk about today is how we can reduce our carbon footprint.
2. Ej.: It wasn't me who cancelled the meeting; it was the client.
3. Ej.: The reason why I am writing is to request a refund for my order.
4. Ej.: What happened was that my flight was cancelled and I missed the conference.
5. Ej.: All I want is a bit more flexibility. What really matters is that we work well together.